

Name:

Form:

MYP 2

Year 8

Earth Sciences



Glossary Earth Sciences

Word	Meaning
Abiogenesis	Is the natural process by which life arises from non-living matter,
Asthenosphere	A part of the upper mantle just below the lithosphere.
Convergent	When two tectonic plates collide and move into each other.
Divergent	When two tectonic plates move away from each other.
Era	Second largest geochronologic time unit. There are ten defined eras including the current era: Cenozoic.
Evolution	The change in the characteristics of a species over several generations
Glacial	A cold period when glaciers are expanding.
Hominim	Any member of the zoological "tribe" Hominini (family Hominidae, order Primates)
Igneous Rocks	Igneous rocks are formed through the cooling and solidification of magma or lava.
Interglacial	A warming period when glaciers and ice sheets are receding.
Lava	Hot molten or semi-fluid rock erupted from a volcano or fissure.
Lithosphere	The hard and rigid outer vertical layer of the Earth, includes the crust and the lithospheric mantle.
Magma	A hot fluid or semi-fluid material below or within the earth's crust from which lava and other igneous rock is formed on cooling.
Metamorphic Rocks	Metamorphic rocks arise from the transformation of existing rock to new types of rock in a process called metamorphism.
MYA	Million years ago.
Natural Selection	Is the survival and reproduction of individuals due to differences in physical characteristics.
Period	A smaller geochronologic time unit. Often used during the time of the dinosaurs (e.g. Jurrassic).
Sedimentary Rocks	A type of rock that is formed by the accumulation or deposition of mineral or organic particles on the Earth's surface.
Speciation	The evolutionary process by which populations evolve to become distinct species.
Subduction	When one tectonic plate slides under another, resulting in tensions and faulting in the earth's crust.

Global Competency: Citizenship, critical thinking

Approach to Learning: Creative thinking, information literacy, reflection

Lesson Sequence

Lesson	Content	Page
1	The Formation of the Earth	
2	Layers of the Earth	
3	Early Stages - Volcanoes and Magma	
4	Make your own Volcano	
5-6	Criterion D - Volcanoes through time	
7	Types of Rocks and their Properties	
8	The Rock Cycle	
9	Plate Tectonics	
10	The Beginning of Life	
11	Earth's Ages and the Dinosaurs	
12	Extinction Events	
13	Ice Ages	
14	Rise of the Mammals	
15	Evolution of Humans	

8ES 1a The Formation of the Earth

Learning Objectives:

All can identify the age of the earth.

Most can develop a model of a timeline of the Earth's formation and plot significant events on this timeline.

Some can explain how scientific theories are constantly being updated as evidence is discovered.

Introduction: *Turn and Talk* to a partner:

Discuss how old the following events in the Earth's history:

How old is the Human Species?

The human species (*Homo sapiens*) is about 300,000 years old; the oldest fossils come from Morocco and Ethiopia.

How old is the Earth?

The Earth is about 4,600 million (4.6 billion) years old; this is dated from meteorites and the oldest Earth rocks.

How old is the Solar System?

The Solar System formed about 4,600 million (4.6 billion) years ago from a cloud of gas and dust.

How old is the Universe?

The Universe is about 13,800 million (13.8 billion) years old, worked out from the expansion of the Universe.

Activity 1.1 Constructing a timeline of the Earth's Formation

Global Competency: Citizenship, critical thinking

Approach to Learning: Creative thinking, information literacy, reflection

GEOLOGICAL TIMELINE

In this pack you will find information and activities to help your class grasp the concept of geological time, just how old our planet is, and just how young we, as a species, are.

Planet Earth is 4,600 million years old. We all know this is very old indeed, but big numbers like this are always difficult to get your head around. The activities in this pack will help your class to make visual representations of the age of the Earth to help them get to grips with the timescales involved.

IMPORTANT EVENTS IN THE EARTH'S HISTORY



4600 mya (million years ago) – Planet Earth formed. Dust left over from the birth of the sun clumped together to form planet Earth. The other planets in our solar system were also formed in this way at about the same time.

4500 mya – Earth's core and crust formed. Dense metals sank to the centre of the Earth and formed the core, while the outside layer cooled and solidified to form the Earth's crust.

4400 mya – The Earth's first oceans formed. Water vapour was released into the Earth's atmosphere by volcanism. It then cooled, fell back down as rain, and formed the Earth's first oceans. Some water may also have been brought to Earth by comets and asteroids.

3850 mya – The first life appeared on Earth. It was very simple single-celled organisms. Exactly how life first arose is a mystery.

1500 mya – Oxygen began to accumulate in the Earth's atmosphere. Oxygen is made by cyanobacteria (blue-green algae) as a product of photosynthesis. For 2,200 million years this oxygen was removed from the atmosphere as it reacted with iron, sank to the bottom of the sea and became trapped in rock layers. 1,500 million years ago the free iron ran out and oxygen began to be released into the atmosphere.

700 mya – The first animals evolved. These were simple single-celled animals.

530 mya – The first vertebrates (fish) evolved.

400 mya – The first land plants evolved. Oxygen in the atmosphere reacted to form ozone, which formed a layer. This served as a protective barrier to the harmful rays coming from space and which allowed plants to colonise the land.

350 mya – The first land vertebrates evolved. With plants present on the land to provide a food source, animals rapidly followed. The first to venture onto the land were primitive amphibians, and reptiles evolved soon afterwards.

225 mya – The first dinosaurs evolved from lizards.

65 mya – The dinosaurs went extinct. The dinosaurs, and many other species with them, were wiped out by the after-effects of a meteorite impact, or perhaps several impacts. The impact(s) set off chains of earthquakes, tsunamis and volcanic eruptions, which threw lots of dust and acid into the atmosphere, creating an impact winter. The dust blocked out the sunlight so plants could no longer photosynthesise, and food chains collapsed. After the extinction of the dinosaurs, mammals evolved rapidly and filled the evolutionary niches they left behind.

130,000 years ago (0.13 mya) – Modern humans evolved. *Homo sapiens* evolved in Africa from earlier humans. They left Africa around 35,000 years ago and spread around the globe. Human evolution is still pretty mysterious, due to gaps in the fossil record.



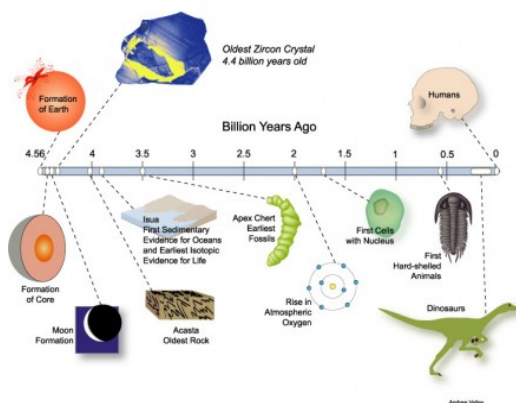
Toilet Paper Timeline Practical

Introduction:

Using the information above, construct a timeline of events of the formation of the Earth from the Formation of the Earth through to the Evolution of Modern Humans. There are 12 major events that should be included on your timeline and these have been provided to you on laminated cards.

Method:

1. Carefully unwind your roll of toilet paper and tape it down to the space you are working in. It is important you do your best not to tear the toilet paper.
2. Count the total number of sheets of toilet paper.
3. Divide the age of the earth (4600 million years ago) by the number of sheets of toilet paper to find the value of one sheet.
4. Working from the formation of the Earth, add the laminated events in the appropriate places along your timeline.
5. Research three additional events that took place and add these as an illustration to your timeline. Some suggested examples could be the creation of the moon? The First Volcanic Eruption? The evolution of the banana plant? Etc.
6. Once you have finished, please use a mobile phone to shoot a short video that runs down the length of your timeline and pauses at each major event to describe it. This can be uploaded to google classroom.



· Three extra events to add to the timeline: formation of the Moon (about 4.5 billion years ago), the first volcanic eruptions, and the evolution of the banana plant.

Research Opportunity

*If you want to deepen your understanding of this topic here is an additional research opportunity and some useful websites you could use.

The British Geological Survey website has some very good information on geological time. There is an interactive online timeline and teachers' notes with more events you could choose to include in your timeline.
<http://www.bgs.ac.uk/discoveringGeology/time/timeline/home.html>

The Science Education Resource Centre has further information on making a toilet paper timeline.
<http://serc.carleton.edu/quantskills/activities/TPGeoTime.html>

This pack links in nicely with the James Hutton and Charles Lyell packs, also provided by Dynamic Earth Education. For more information see the Dynamic Earth website support materials section.
<http://www.dynamicearth.co.uk/learning/curriculum-for-excellence/support-materials>

There is a very good free app called EarthViewer that lets users explore different aspects of the Earth's deep history, including plate tectonics, climate and fossils.

<http://www.hhmi.org/biointeractive/earthviewer>

Something interesting I learnt from my own research was:

The Earth formed about 4,600 million (4.6 billion) years ago from a cloud of dust and gas.

Life first appeared in the oceans about 3,800 million years ago as simple single-celled organisms.

Oxygen only built up in the atmosphere about 2,400 million years ago, after photosynthesis by early life (the Great Oxidation Event).

The first animals with hard shells appeared about 540 million years ago in the Cambrian explosion.

The dinosaurs and many other species died out about 66 million years ago after an asteroid impact.

Modern humans have existed for only about 300,000 years - a tiny fraction of Earth's 4.6 billion-year history.

Earth's continents have drifted over time, forming the supercontinent Pangaea about 250 million years ago.

From my research I learnt that the Earth is 4.6 billion years old, yet modern humans have only existed for the last 0.3 million years.

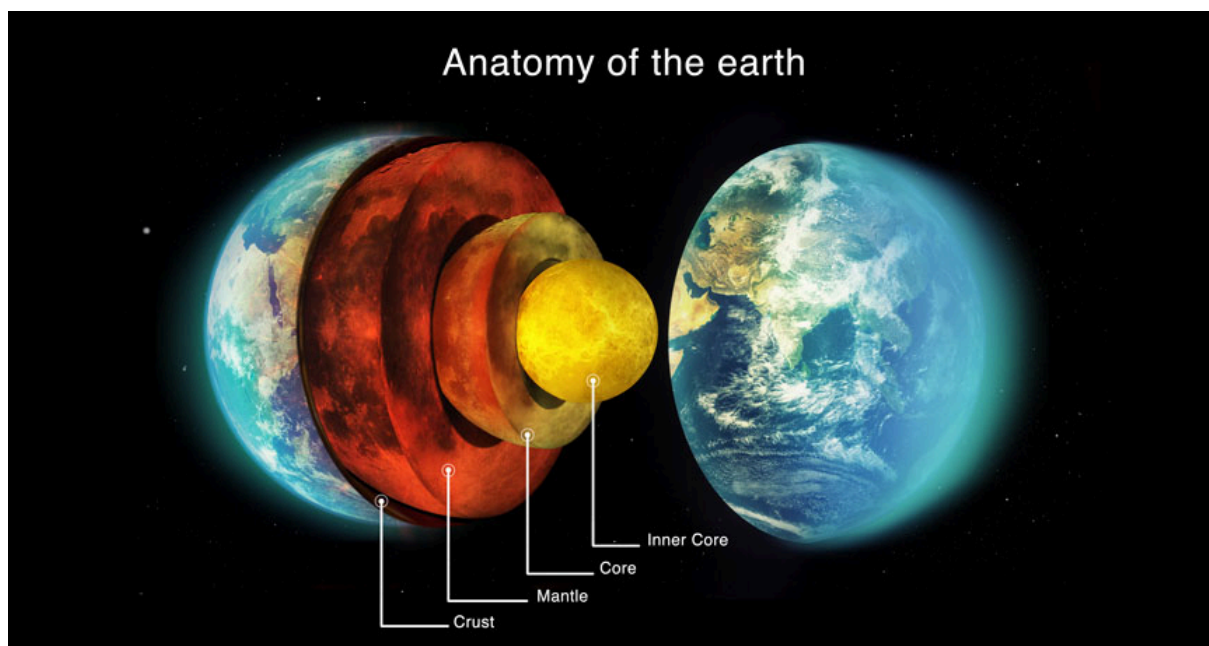
8ES 2a Layers of the Earth

Mountain ranges tower to the sky. Oceans plummet to impossible depths. Earth's surface is an amazing place to behold. Yet even the deepest canyon is but a tiny scratch on the planet. To really understand Earth, you need to travel **6,400 kilometers** beneath our feet.

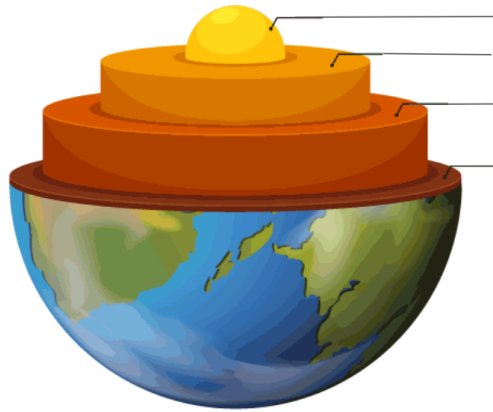
Starting at the centre, Earth is composed of four distinct layers. They are, from deepest to shallowest, the inner core, the outer core, the mantle and the crust. Except for the crust, no one has ever explored these layers in person. In fact, the deepest humans have ever drilled is just over **12 kilometers**. And even that took 20 years!

Still, scientists know a great deal about Earth's inner structure. They've plumbed it by studying how earthquake waves travel through the planet. The speed and behaviour of these waves change as they encounter layers of different densities. Scientists — including **Isaac Newton**, three centuries ago — have also learned about the core and mantle from calculations of Earth's total density, gravitational pull and magnetic field.

Geiger, B. (2019, November 11). *Explainer: Earth — layer by layer*. Science News, Explores. Retrieved October 31, 2023, from <https://www.snexplores.org/article/explainer-earth-layer-layer>



THE LAYERS OF EARTH



Layer:	Distance from Surface	Thickness:

Earth's crust ranges from 5 - 70 Km in depth and is the outermost layer. Oceanic crust is more dense than continental crust which causes it to slide beneath the continental crust when they meet. This rubbing causes earthquakes. There are several large pieces of continental crust called tectonic plates that move very slowly.

At almost 3000 km thick, the mantle is the earth's thickest layer. It is very dense and hot and also only semi-solid, which means it circulates slowly around the earth.

The core is made up of the inner core and outer core and is mostly made of Iron and Nickel. These are heavy metals which is why they sank to the centre of the earth and formed the core. The inner core is solid, while the outer core is liquid and also circulates around the earth.

5 - 70 Km continental earthquakes tectonic plates mantle semi-solid

Iron Nickel sank liquid

8ES 2b Creating a Model of the Earth

Option 1: Modelling Clay

Apparatus:
At least 4 colours of clay
Flag toothpicks

Method:

1. Make a small ball with one colour of clay
2. Wrap another layer of different colour clay
3. Wrap 2 more layers of different colour clay
4. Cut out a wedge to show all 4 layers of the earth.
5. Using flag toothpicks (or string with paper), list out all relevant information for each layer.



Option 2: Coloured Paper

Apparatus:
At least 4 colours of paper
String

Method:

1. Cut out 4 circles of paper of increasing diameter representing each layer of the earth.
2. Glue each layer on top of the other, starting with the biggest and working down to the smallest.
3. Stick string on each layer and connect to another piece of paper.
4. For each layer list relevant information.



Extension: Research and add to the model the Lithosphere and Asthenosphere, the depth and thickness as well as the purpose.

Extension: add the lithosphere (crust plus rigid upper mantle) lying on the asthenosphere (soft, semi-molten upper mantle) which the plates move on.

Global Competency: Citizenship, critical thinking

Approach to Learning: Creative thinking, information literacy, reflection

8ES 3a Early Stages of the Earth - Volcanoes and magma

In Earth's Beginning

At its beginning, Earth was unrecognizable from its modern form. At first, it was extremely hot, to the point that the planet likely consisted almost entirely of **molten magma**. Over the course of a few hundred million years, the planet began to cool and oceans of liquid water formed. **Heavy elements began sinking** past the oceans and magma toward the center of the planet. As this occurred, Earth became **differentiated into layers**, with the outermost layer being a solid covering of relatively lighter material while the denser, molten material sunk to the center.

Scientists believe that Earth, like the other inner planets, came to its current state in three different stages. The first stage, described above, is known as **accretion**, or the formation of a planet from the existing particles within the solar system as they collided with each other to form larger and larger bodies. Scientists believe the next stage involved the collision of a protoplanet with a very young planet Earth. This is thought to have occurred more than 4.5 billion years ago and may have resulted in the formation of Earth's moon. The final stage of development saw the bombardment of the planet with asteroids.

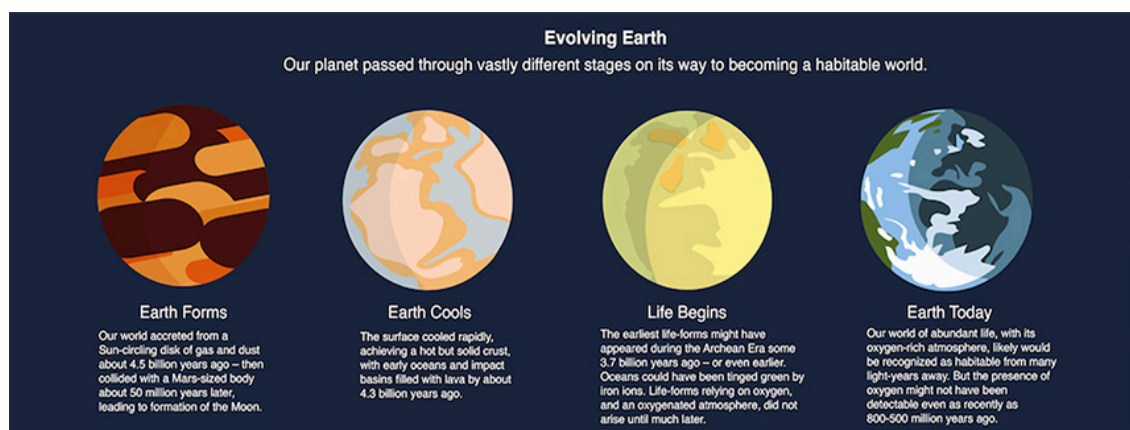
Earth's early atmosphere was most likely composed of hydrogen and helium. As the planet changed, and the crust began to form, **volcanic eruptions occurred frequently**. These volcanoes pumped water vapor, ammonia, and carbon dioxide into the atmosphere around Earth. Slowly, the oceans began to take shape, and eventually, primitive life evolved in those oceans.

Formation of Earth. (n.d.). National Geographic Society. Retrieved November 7, 2023, from

<https://education.nationalgeographic.org/resource/formation-earth/>

Geiger, B. (2019, November 11). *Explainer: Earth — layer by layer*. Science News Explores. Retrieved October 31, 2023, from

<https://www.snexplores.org/article/explainer-earth-layer-layer>



8ES 3b Questions

1. How old is the earth? How do we know?: _____

The Earth is about 4.6 billion years old. We know this from radiometric dating of the oldest rocks and of meteorites.

2. Scientists believe the moon was formed during the second stage of earth's development.

How do they think this happened ? _____

3. Why was the early earth hot? _____

A protoplanet collided with the very young Earth over 4.5 billion years ago; the debris thrown into orbit clumped together to form the Moon.

The early Earth was heated by constant collisions (accretion) and by radioactive decay, so it was almost entirely molten magma.

4. What minerals make up the earth's crust? And why is this so?

5. List at least 3 gases released by volcanoes in the early formation of

The crust is made of silicate minerals containing oxygen and silicon; the denser iron and nickel sank to the core so lighter minerals stayed on top.

earth? _____

Volcanoes released water vapour (steam), carbon dioxide and ammonia (also nitrogen and sulphur dioxide).

6. When did the continents form and why does the continental crust rise above the oceanic crust?

The continents formed as the crust cooled and thickened, about 4 billion years ago. Continental crust is thicker and less dense than oceanic crust, so it floats higher.

Global Competency: Citizenship, critical thinking

Approach to Learning: Creative thinking, information literacy, reflection

8ES 3C Volcanoes and Magma

Using the space below draw and annotate a volcano. Make sure you list as much information as you can. You should have such features as magma, lava, crater, secondary side vent, gases etc.

· Annotated volcano: magma chamber below ground, main vent, crater at the top, lava flowing down the slopes, secondary (side) vent, and ash and gases erupting.

Extension: Research and list different types of volcanoes, their primary differences and examples around the world /OR/ Research historic volcanic eruptions: when they occurred and their impact.

· *Extension:* shield volcanoes (runny lava, gentle slopes), composite/strato volcanoes (thick sticky lava, steep, explosive) and cinder cones (small, ash and cinders).

Global Competency: Citizenship, critical thinking

Approach to Learning: Creative thinking, information literacy, reflection

8ES 4a Making your own Volcano

Types of Volcanoes

Types of Volcanoes			
Volcano Type	Characteristics	Examples	Simplified Diagram
Flood or Plateau Basalt	Very liquid lava; flows very widespread; emitted from fractures	Columbia River Plateau	
Shield Volcano	Liquid lava emitted from a central vent; large; sometimes has a collapse caldera	Larch Mountain, Mount Sylvania, Highland Butte, Hawaiian volcanoes	
Cinder Cone	Explosive liquid lava; small; emitted from a central vent; if continued long enough, may build up a shield volcano	Mount Tabor, Mount Zion, Chamberlain Hill, Pilot Butte, Lava Butte, Craters of the Moon	
Composite or Stratovolcano	More viscous lavas, much explosive (pyroclastic) debris; large, emitted from a central vent	Mount Baker, Mount Rainier, Mount St. Helens, Mount Hood, Mount Shasta	
Volcanic Dome	Very viscous lava; relatively small; can be explosive; commonly occurs adjacent to craters of composite volcanoes	Novarupta, Mount St. Helens Lava Dome, Mount Lassen, Shastina, Mono Craters	
Caldera	Very large composite volcano collapsed after an explosive period; frequently associated with plug domes	Crater Lake, Newberry, Kilauea, Long Valley, Medicine Lake, Yellowstone	

· Types of volcanoes: shield, composite (strato), cinder cone, caldera and fissure eruptions; they differ in lava type, shape and how explosive they are.

Looking the above examples, in groups of 3 or 4 - choose a type of volcano to make using the instructions below. You can watch this video for tips:

[How to make a volcano: A super quick and easy project | Natural History Museum](#)

Apparatus:

You will need the following items:

- Two A3 sheets of card
- 500 ml plastic bottle
- Scissors
- Tape
- Paint and paintbrushes
- 3 tbsp bicarbonate of soda (baking soda)
- 3 tbsp washing up liquid
- 180ml water
- 1.5 cups vinegar
- 2 tbsp red food colouring

Method:

1. Place your bottle upside down in the centre of a sheet of card and draw a small circle around the neck. Cut a straight line through the card to the middle of the circle, and cut out the circle.
2. Overlap the two sides of the card to make a cone shape. Tape this into place, leaving a hole where you cut out the circle and cut around the base of the cone so that it sits flat, but make sure that it is still taller than your bottle. Tape the base of the cone to the other sheet of card.
3. Use paint to decorate the cone and make it look like a volcano. Allow your model to dry.
4. In a bowl, combine the bicarbonate of soda and washing up liquid. Add the water and mix thoroughly. Pour this mixture into your volcano.
5. In a cup, mix together the vinegar and food colouring.
6. When you're ready, pour the vinegar into the bottle with the bicarbonate. Wait for it to erupt and watch how the lava flows.

8ES 4b Follow Up Questions

1. What type of volcano did you make?

A cone-shaped model (composite/stratovolcano shape); the vinegar and bicarbonate make a frothy 'lava' that flows like a shield volcano eruption.

We made a composite (strato) volcano with a cone shape and steep sides, like a real explosive volcano.

2. Why did your volcano erupt?

3. When did your 'magma' become 'lava'?

The vinegar (acid) reacted with the bicarbonate of soda (alkali) to make carbon dioxide gas; the gas pressure built up and pushed the foam out like lava.

The 'magma' became 'lava' as soon as it left the vent (bottle neck) and flowed out onto the surface of the model.

4. How would you improve your volcano for next time?

Use more bicarbonate and vinegar, add extra washing-up liquid for longer foam, seal the cone tighter and widen the vent so lava flows down the sides.

Next time we would measure the ingredients accurately, tape the cone tighter and widen the vent so the eruption is slower and longer lasting.



MYP 2: Year 8 Science

Criterion D Assessment - Reflecting the Impacts of Science

UNIT:	Earth Science
ASSESSMENT TITLE:	Volcanos through time
Inquiry Statement	Exploring relationships in the environment that result from interactions between organisms.
Key Concept:	Relationships
Related Concepts:	Environment, Interaction

Assignment Instructions (GRASPS)

Goal	Produce a Newscast that would be on the 6 o'clock news explaining about a volcano that is currently erupting.
Role	You must work on this task in groups of FOUR. Each person in the group will assume a different role from the following list; 1. News anchor News anchor: introduces the newscast, welcomes the audience and links to each specialist with questions. 2. Science specialist 3. Weather meteorologist 4. Environmentalist
Audience	Global News Network Science specialist: explains the science - why the volcano erupted, magma type, plate boundary and eruption data.
Situation	A volcano has just erupted and is spewing hot ash and lava into the air. Citizens are panicking and are looking for news about the impacts on their lives and global affairs this type of eruption might cause.
Product	Produce a group Newscast in which you discuss a famous volcanic eruption from time. The Newscast should be no more than a TOTAL of 5 minutes in length, allowing each member of your group to provide a 1min 20s segment. Try and imitate a traditional newscast you might see in an emergency situation.
Success Criteria for Assessment	In your podcast you will: - Clearly explain the local and global impact that a volcanic eruption can have - You refer to data to support your argument and facts presented. - You must use accurate scientific terminology in your verbal communication in the Newscast. - Your Newscast should be factually accurate and based on valid historic and scientific data. Sources must be cited. Weather meteorologist: explains atmospheric effects - ash clouds, blocked sunlight, cooling, wind direction and ash fall.

Other Information: You MUST provide a Bibliography and cite all your sources.

Due Date: this will be set by your teacher.

Environmentalist: explains impacts on habitats, ecosystems, air quality and crops, and how the area might recover.

Global Competency: Citizenship, critical thinking

Approach to Learning: Creative thinking, information literacy, reflection

Level Descriptors and Task Specific Clarifications for Criterion D:

Level	Level Descriptor	Task Specific Clarification
0	The student does not reach a standard described by any of the descriptors below.	No data or clear evidence provided.
1-2	The student is able to, with limited success : i. state the ways in which science is used to address a specific problem or issue ii. state the implications of using science to solve a specific problem or issue, interacting with a factor iii. apply scientific language to communicate understanding iv. document sources.	ii. Student simply state there is a volcano erupting and do not provide information specific to the volcano chose ii. Lack data to underpin their arguments or points discussed.. iii. Little evidence of scientific vocabulary being used. iv. Source of information given, but not correctly referenced.
3-4	The student is able to: i. Outline the ways in which science is used to address a specific problem or issue ii. Outline the implications of using science to solve a specific problem or issue, interacting with a factor iii. sometimes apply scientific language to communicate understanding iv. sometimes document sources correctly.	i. A specific example of a volcano is chosen and data provided is valid to their specific example ii. Students provide at least 1 point of view from a specialist on the impacts of a volcanic eruption of this scale iii. Some scientific vocabulary is used. iv. Bibliography has only three sources referenced, but this may not be accurately formatted.
5-6	The student is able to: i. Summarize the ways in which science is used to address a specific problem or issue ii. Describe the implications of using science to solve a specific problem or issue, interacting with a factor iii. usually apply scientific language to communicate understanding clearly and precisely iv. usually document sources correctly.	i. The chosen volcano is contextualized into its specific time period and the students identify the impacts it would have had. ii. Multiple points of view are evaluated and describe by specialists on the newscast iii. Some good scientific vocabulary is used. iv. At least 5 sources are referenced in APA format

7-8	The student is able to: i. Describe the ways in which science is applied and used to address a specific problem or issue ii. Describe and summarize the implications of using science and its application to solve a specific problem or issue, interacting with a factor iii. consistently apply scientific language to communicate understanding clearly and precisely iv. document sources completely	i. The Volcano is described in context to its time period. The economic, scientific, environmental impacts are considered and explained during the newscast by students. ii. Comparison to more modern volcanic impacts included iii. Explanations involve excellent scientific vocabulary. iv. Correct bibliography is provided citing at least 5 reputable and relevant sources, in APA format. Sources are also referenced in the script using APA format.

8ES 7a Types of Rocks and their Properties

What do you know about rocks?

Rocks are solids made of grains of minerals. There are three types: igneous, sedimentary and metamorphic.

Have you seen different types of rocks? What makes them different?

Yes - rocks differ in colour, texture, grain size, hardness and in the minerals or fossils they contain.

The crust is the Earth's outer layer and is made of **rocks**. Rocks are solids which are made of **grains of minerals** which fit together.

Minerals are chemical compounds which occur naturally in the Earth's **crust**. A compound is a substance which is made from two or more elements which are chemically bonded together in a fixed ratio of atoms.

Rocks can be classified into three types depending on what minerals they contain and how they are formed.

The **three types of rock** are:

- Igneous
- Metamorphic
- Sedimentary

Rock types - The Earth and atmosphere - KS3 Chemistry - BBC Bitesize. (n.d.). BBC. Retrieved January 8, 2024, from <https://www.bbc.co.uk/bitesize/articles/zpygcmn#zb9wqfr>

8ES 7b Types of Rocks and their Properties

	Igneous	Sedimentary	Metamorphic
How are they formed	Formed when magma (underground) or lava (at the surface) cools and solidifies.	Formed when sediments are deposited in layers, then compacted and cemented together over time.	Formed from existing rock changed by intense heat and/or pressure deep in the crust, without melting.
Diagram of Formation	Diagram: magma or lava cooling - crystals grow as the molten rock solidifies.	Diagram: layers of sediment settling under water, then being squeezed and cemented into rock.	Diagram: rock deep underground heated and squeezed so its minerals recrystallise.
Characteristics	Crystalline with interlocking crystals, hard and dense, no fossils and no layers; slow cooling gives large crystals.	Soft/friable, arranged in layers (strata), grains often rounded, porous, and may contain fossils.	Hard and dense, often banded (foliated) with flattened crystals; usually no fossils.
Examples	Granite, basalt, obsidian and pumice.	Sandstone, limestone, shale, chalk and coal.	Marble (from limestone), slate (from shale), quartzite and gneiss.

8ES 7c Properties of Rocks and Classification

Practical: Properties of Rocks

Collect a sample of rocks, including examples of igneous, sedimentary, and metamorphic rocks. Observe and explore the samples using hand lenses or magnifying glasses.

Identify and describe the following properties of rocks:

Colour: What is the predominant colour of the rock? e.g. mostly grey with white and dark speckles (example: granite).

Texture: Is the rock rough, smooth, grainy, or glassy?

e.g. rough and grainy - individual crystals are visible (coarse-grained), not smooth or glassy.

Hardness: Can the rock be scratched with a fingernail, penny, or other objects?

Hard - not scratched by a fingernail or a copper penny, and it can scratch glass (e.g. granite).

Composition: Does the rock contain visible minerals or fossils?

Contains visible minerals such as quartz, feldspar and mica; no fossils visible.

Weight: Is the rock heavy or lightweight? Heavy and dense for its size - feels solid rather than light and porous.

Other properties: Aspects like transparency, magnetism, or smell (if relevant).

Activity: Rock Classification

- Divide into small groups of 3-4.
- Using paper and markers: create a classification chart to organise the rock samples into the three main types: igneous, sedimentary, and metamorphic.
- Write the properties of each rock type under the respective categories on the chart paper.

8ES 8 The Rock Cycle

Learning Objectives:

All are able to describe the structure of igneous, sedimentary and metamorphic rock

Most can explain the process of the rock cycle and know how rock can be changed from one type to another.

Some can explain how geographic regions favour the production of certain types of rock.

Introduction: *Recap of the types of rock*

What are the physical properties of sedimentary rock

Sedimentary rock is usually soft, made of layers (strata), often contains fossils and is porous and grainy.

Where does igneous rock get produced?

Igneous rock is produced where magma or lava cools - at volcanoes, mid-ocean ridges and deep underground in the crust.

Give an example of a type of metamorphic rock

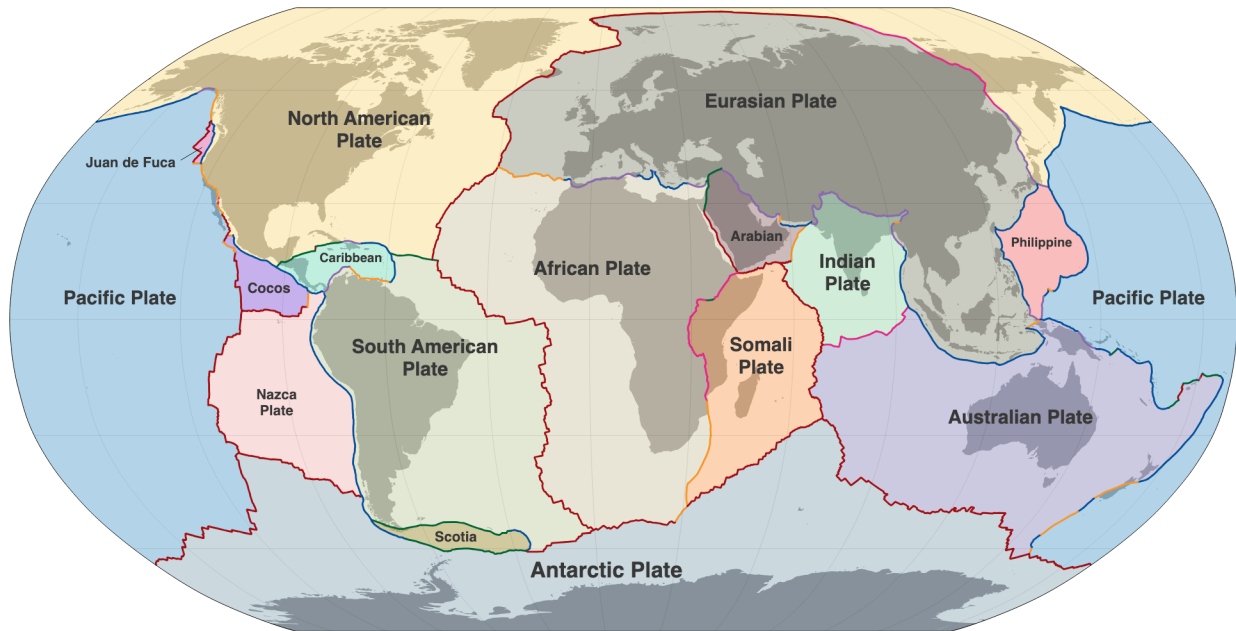
Marble (formed from limestone) and slate (formed from shale) are examples of metamorphic rock.

Activity 1.1 The Choc Rock Cycle

We are going to build a model of the Rock Cycle using chocolate to explain and simplify some of the complicated processes.

8ES 9a Plate Tectonics

Plate tectonics is a scientific theory that explains how major landforms are created as a result of Earth's subterranean movements. The theory, which solidified in the 1960s, transformed the earth sciences by explaining many phenomena, including **mountain building** events, **volcanoes**, and **earthquakes**.



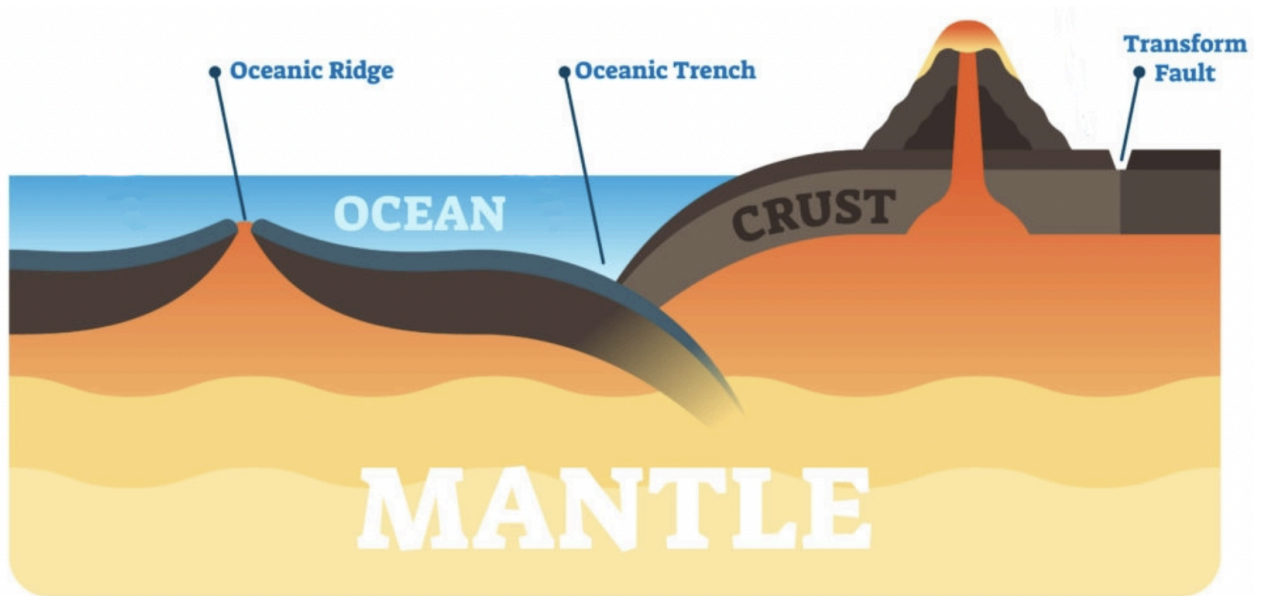
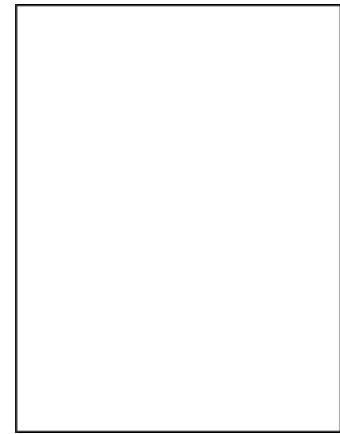
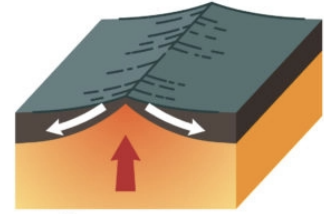
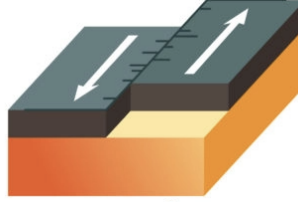
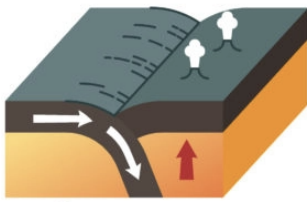
In plate tectonics, Earth's outermost layer, or **lithosphere**—made up of the crust and upper mantle—is broken into large rocky plates. These plates lie on top of a partially molten layer of rock called the **asthenosphere**. Due to the convection of the asthenosphere and lithosphere, the plates move relative to each other at different rates, from two to 15 centimeters (one to six inches) per year. This interaction of tectonic plates is responsible for many different geological formations such as the Himalaya mountain range in Asia, the East African Rift, and the San Andreas Fault in California, United States.

Gerster, G. (2023, October 19). Plate Tectonics. National Geographic Society. Retrieved January 10, 2024, from <https://education.nationalgeographic.org/resource/plate-tectonics/>

8ES 9b Plate Boundaries

Under each picture, give the name of the plate boundary and describe its motion. Then draw a line to where it occurs on the picture below:

· Divergent boundary - plates move apart. Convergent boundary - plates collide and one is subducted. Transform boundary - plates slide past each other.



· On the world map: divergent = mid-Atlantic ridge; convergent = Andes/Himalaya; transform = San Andreas Fault.

8ES 9c Earthquake Proofing

Faults are fractures in Earth's crust where movement has occurred. Sometimes faults move when energy is released from a sudden slip of the rocks on either side. Most earthquakes occur along plate boundaries along the faults.

Practical: Earthquake Proofing

Research:

- Conduct research on different types of earthquake-resistant structures (e.g., base isolation, damping systems, and triangular bracing).
- In small groups, discuss and sketch out their ideas for an earthquake-proof structure.
- Consider the materials, design, and construction techniques that will enhance the structure's stability

· Earthquake-resistant structures: base isolation (flexible bearings), damping systems (shock absorbers), triangular bracing, cross-bracing and shear walls.

Construct:

- Using the provided materials work in groups to build your designs, following your initial sketches and incorporating your chosen materials.

Test:

- Your teacher will now test your construction through a simulated Earthquake!
- Observe and record the performance of each structure during the simulated earthquake. Note any signs of collapse, deformation, or stability.

8ES 9c Earthquake Proofing

Use this page for initial sketches and designs:

· Sketch should label the wide low base, triangular bracing, cross-bracing, damping bearings and the materials used.

Observations and Analysis after testing:

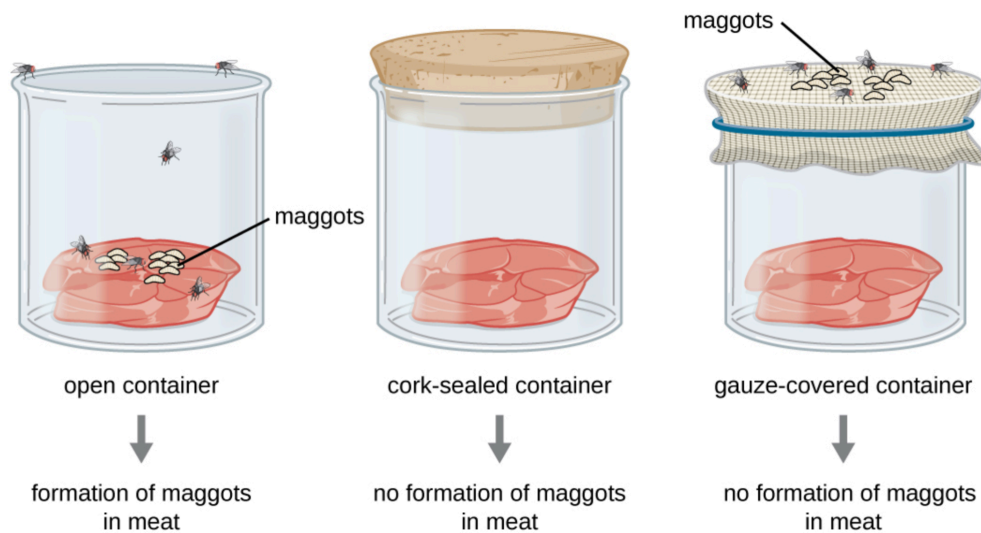
· Observations and analysis: the wide, low structure with triangular bracing stayed upright; the tall top-heavy design toppled because the shaking moved its centre of mass.

8ES 10a The Beginning of Life

Life may have begun when lightning and UV radiation gave energy that turned simple gases and organic molecules in the early oceans into complex molecules, which later formed the first simple cells.

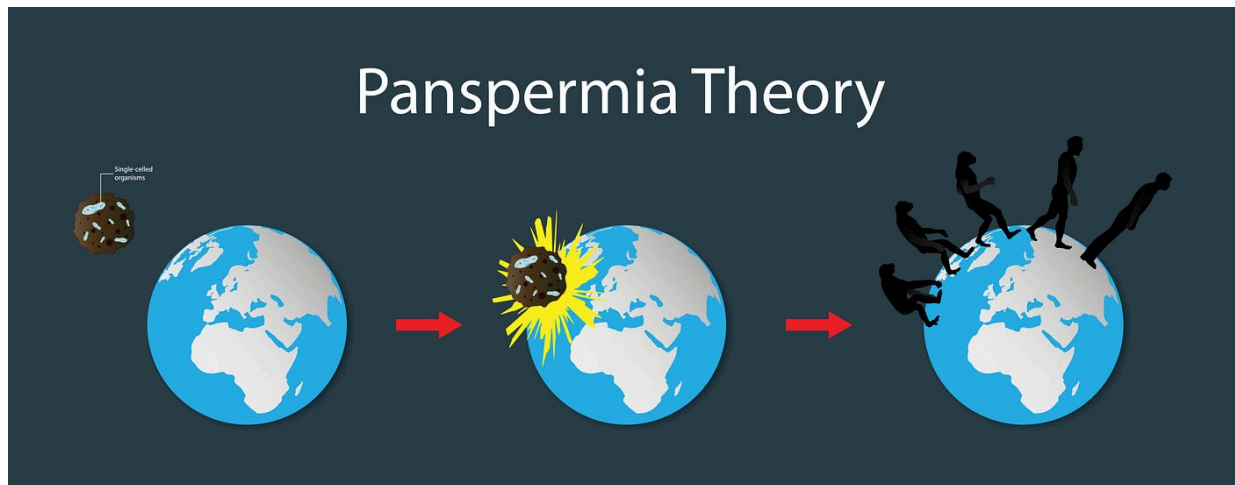
How do you think life on Earth started? Be as descriptive as possible in your answer below:

The Greek philosopher Aristotle (384–322 BC) was one of the earliest recorded scholars to articulate the theory of **spontaneous generation**, the notion that life can arise from nonliving matter. Aristotle proposed that life arose from nonliving material if the material contained pneuma (“vital heat”). As evidence, he noted several instances of the appearance of animals from environments previously devoid of such animals, such as the seemingly sudden appearance of fish in a new puddle of water.



Francesco Redi's (1626–1697) experiment disproving spontaneous generation

The idea that life can be distributed throughout the universe, from planet to planet, is called panspermia.



Place Evidence in the Correct Column

✓ **Supports Panspermia**
1. Interstellar dust is largely organic sugar molecules including ribose detected in meteorites; 5. Some microorganisms can survive in lab created simulations of space.

✓ **Does not support Panspermia**
2. Meteorites can be contaminated as they enter Earth's atmosphere; 3. Space has extreme temperatures and pressures unforgiving to most life forms; 4. There is no known life on other planets.

1. Interstellar dust is largely organic sugar molecules including ribose detected in meteorites
2. Meteorites can be contaminated with organic molecules as it enters earth's atmosphere
3. Space has extreme temperatures and pressures that are unforgiving to most life forms
4. There is no known life on other planets.
5. Some microorganisms can survive in lab created simulations of space

8ES 10b Abiogenesis

Abiogenesis, is the scientific concept that proposes how life could have originated from Non-living matter. According to the primordial soup theory, early Earth's oceans contained a mixture of organic molecules that gradually formed more complex compounds.

Simple organic molecules, such as amino acids and nucleotides, could have come together to form more complex organic compounds. The process of abiogenesis suggests that over time, the concentration and complexity of these organic molecules Increased.

Abiogenesis is distinct from the theory of evolution, which explains how life has diversified and changed over time.

Another hypothesis related to the origin of life is the panspermia theory, which proposes that life on Earth may have originated from microorganisms or organic molecules that arrived from space.

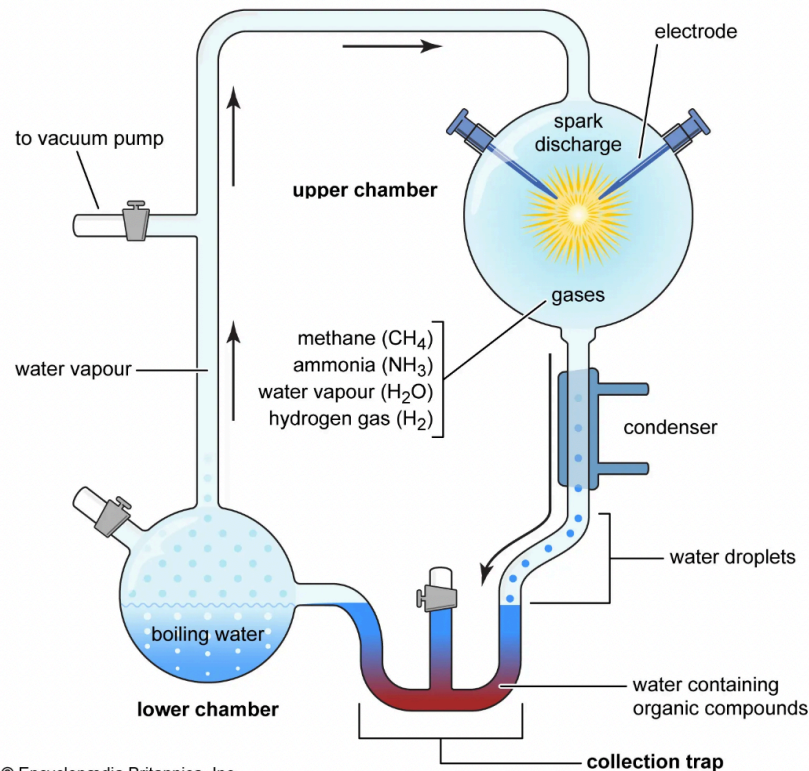
It was thought that Lightning storms and UV radiation provided energy necessary to arrange simple molecules of into the basic building blocks of organic compounds

Early life forms were continuously bombarded by UV radiation, causing Mutations that produced new life forms

Increased	Non-living matter	Lightning storms
primordial soup	amino acids	panspermia
Mutations	UV radiation	evolution

8ES 10c Miller-Urey Experiment

Miller-Urey experiment



Draw a line from the experiment to what it simulates below:

Ancient Oceans

Ancient atmosphere

Lightning Storms

Place Evidence in the Correct Column

Supports abiogenesis - Statements 1 and 3: primitive Earth's atmosphere was extremely hot and electrically charged, and Miller and Urey simulated it, forming biomolecules within one week.

✓ **Supports Abiogenesis**

Does not support abiogenesis - Statement 2: geological evidence suggests Earth's early atmosphere was not the same as the one used in the Miller-Urey experiment.

✓ **Does not support Abiogenesis**

1. Primitive earth's atmosphere was extremely hot and electrically charged
2. Geological Evidence suggests that earth's atmosphere was not the same as the Miller-Urey Experiment
3. Miller and Urey created a simulation of earth's atmosphere and found that biomolecules had formed within just one week.

Global Competency: Citizenship, critical thinking

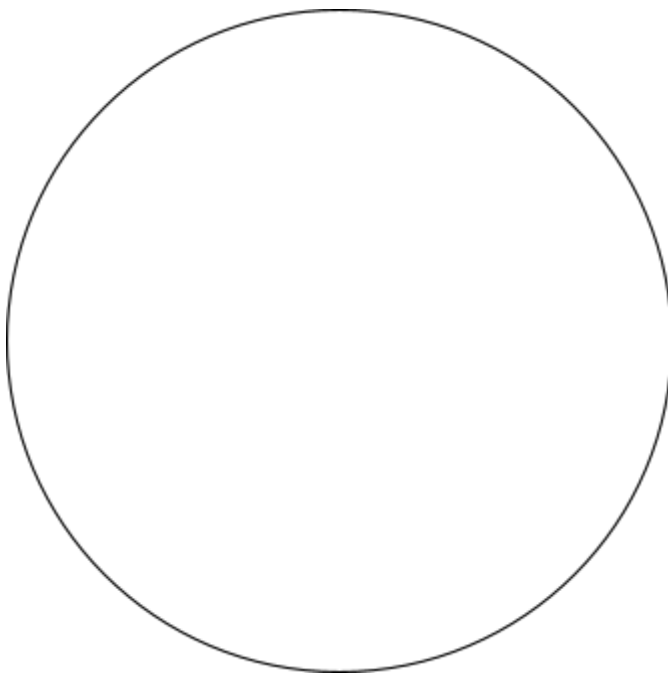
Approach to Learning: Creative thinking, information literacy, reflection

8ES 10d Life in a drop of Seawater

Practical: Life in a drop of Seawater

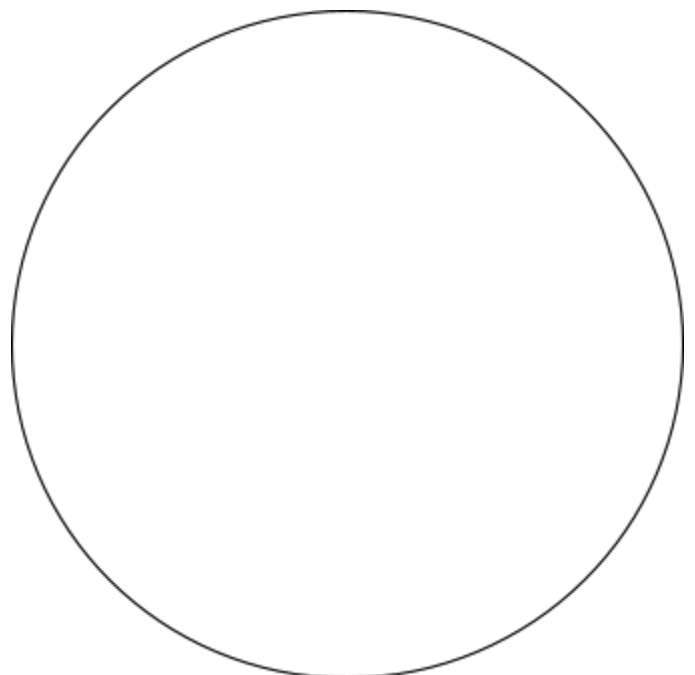
Activity:

- Look at one drop of seawater under a microscope at different magnifications
- Draw what you observe below



Magnification:

Magnification:



· Expected observation: mostly clear water with salt crystals, tiny green algae (diatoms), moving protozoa and small copepods; label magnification used (e.g. x40, x100).

8ES 11a Earth's Ages and the Dinosaurs

Using the National Geographic infographic design your own flow chart of the different geological era's below:

(<https://education.nationalgeographic.org/resource/age-earth/>)

· Flow chart (oldest -> youngest): Hadean -> Archean -> Proterozoic (Precambrian) -> Phanerozoic eras: Palaeozoic -> Mesozoic -> Cenozoic. Key events: first life, first land plants, age of dinosaurs, rise of humans.

8ES 11b Dating Rocks and Fossils

Relative dating: working out the order of rocks and fossils from oldest to youngest by comparing their positions in layers of rock, without giving an exact age.

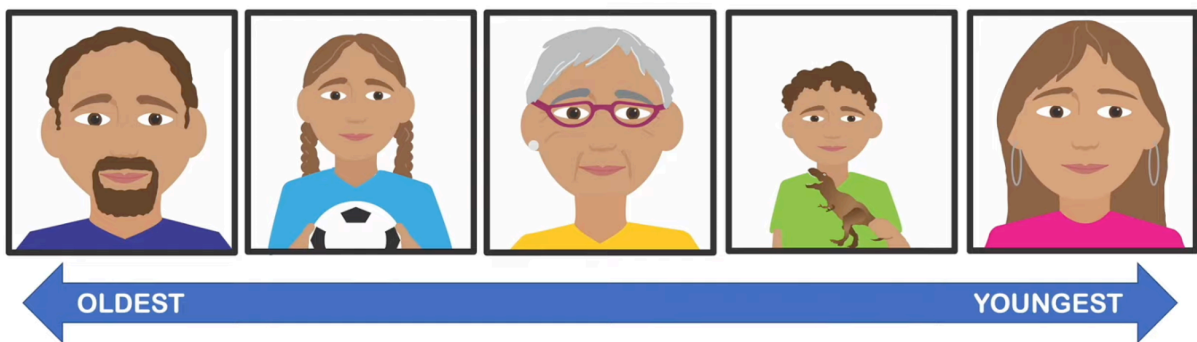
Define Relative Dating:

Absolute dating: finding an actual age in years for a rock or fossil, e.g. by measuring how much radioactive isotope has decayed (e.g. 65 million years old).

Define Absolute Dating:

Relative Dating:

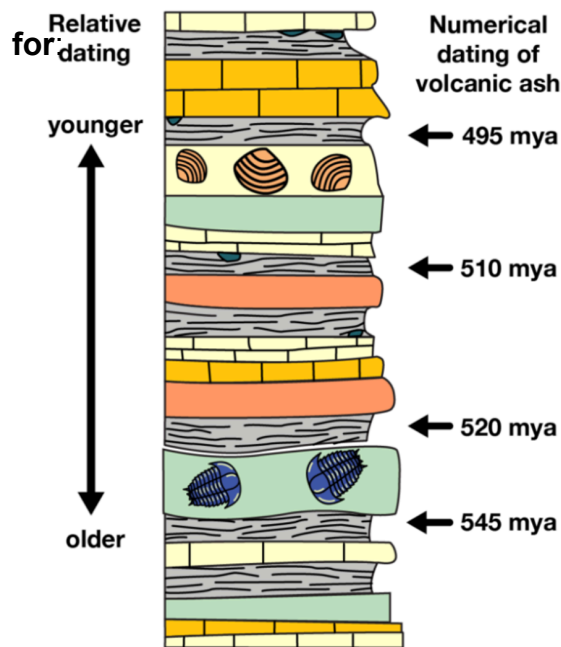
Organise the family below into order of oldest to youngest:



· Oldest to youngest: grandparent (eldest) -> parent -> older sibling -> younger sibling - read from the lowest layer at the bottom of the diagram upwards (superposition).

As shown in the diagram, fossils found in lower strata were deposited earlier and thus must be older than fossils in higher **strata** (this principle is known as **superposition**).

Chronology. (n.d.). Understanding Evolution. Retrieved February 26, 2024, from <https://evolution.berkeley.edu/lines-of-evidence/distribution-in-time-and-space/chronology/>



Layers of Strata

Suggest Approximate ages



· Suggested ages (bottom = oldest): bottom layer about 400-500 million years, then about 250 million, about 100 million, and top layer about 1-5 million years old.

Extension. Research and suggest reasons why relative dating sometimes doesn't work

In your own words, briefly describe what Radiometric dating is, and how it is different to Relative dating:

Radiometric dating measures the decay of radioactive isotopes in a rock to give an actual age in years.
Relative dating only puts rocks in order of age, giving no number.

Looking at the list below, classify them into each column based on whether you would use Carbon-14 dating, or Uranium-Lead dating:

Carbon-14: Bones from a Neandertal; Ancient Cave Painting; Remains of Ancient Plants.

Carbon-14

Uranium-Lead

Uranium-Lead: Igneous Rocks; Precious Gem Stones (e.g. Diamonds); Lunar samples brought back from the moon; Zircon minerals within rocks.

Igneous Rocks

Bones from a Neandertal

Ancient Cave Painting

Precious Gem Stones (e.g. Diamonds)

Remains of Ancient Plants

Lunar samples brought back from the moon

Remains of Ancient Plants

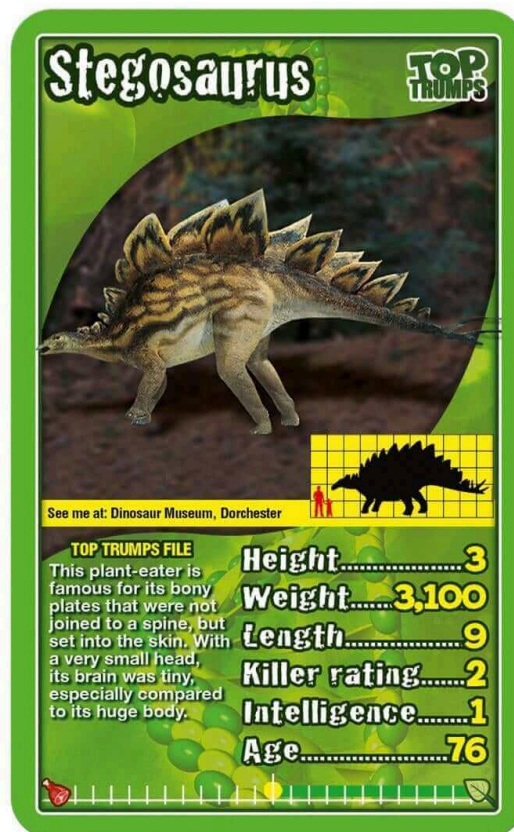
Zircon minerals within rocks

8ES 11c Dinosaur Top Trumps

Research Activity:

- In your group you are to design three Dinosaur top trump cards.
- The categories on each card must include:
 - You must include the Period (Cretaceous, Jurassic, Triassic - including the age of this Period in MYA) - **must have one from each period**
 - State whether it was a carnivore or herbivore - **must have at least one each**
 - When it was discovered
 - How many fossils have been found - **in full skeletons**
 - Height - **in m**
 - Weight - **in kg**
- You must also have a short summary statement as shown below.

· Model cards: T. rex (Cretaceous, 68-66 MYA, carnivore, discovered 1902, about 12 skeletons, 4 m, 8000 kg); Brachiosaurus (Jurassic, 154-150 MYA, herbivore, 1900, 12 m, 35000 kg); Coelophysis (Triassic, 215-208 MYA, carnivore, 1881, 3 m, 25 kg).



8ES 12a Extinction Events

What denotes a mass extinction event?

A mass extinction is when a very large proportion of species (about 75% or more) die out in a geologically short time, across many different groups worldwide.

What is often used to measure extinction rates? Why?

The fossil record is used: the number and type of species that disappear from the rocks shows how fast extinction was happening, because it is the only long-term record of past life.

What is background extinction?

Background extinction is the normal, slow, continuous rate at which a few species die out all the time, in between mass extinction events.

What is the difference between the magnitude of extinction and the rate of extinction?

Magnitude is how many species (the total number or proportion) are lost; rate is how quickly they are lost, e.g. number of species lost per year.

What is a common outcome and cause of an extinction event?

Cause: rapid environmental change (asteroid impact, volcanism, climate change). Outcome: huge loss of biodiversity, then surviving species radiate into the empty niches.

What is speciation?

Speciation is the formation of a new species when populations become isolated, evolve separately by natural selection and can no longer interbreed.

8ES 12b Causes of Extinction Events

1. Climate Change:

Cause: Changes in long-term climate patterns, such as global warming or cooling, can occur due to factors like volcanic activity, variations in solar radiation, or changes in atmospheric composition.

Effect: Shifts in temperature and precipitation patterns can disrupt ecosystems, leading to habitat loss, altered species distributions, and changes in food availability. Many species may struggle to adapt to these changes, resulting in reduced populations or extinction.

2. Asteroid or Comet Impacts:

Cause: Large asteroids or comets colliding with Earth can release massive amounts of energy, causing widespread devastation and environmental changes.

Effect: The impact can trigger fires, release dust and debris into the atmosphere, cause tsunamis, and result in a significant climate change due to the blocking of sunlight. These effects can lead to the extinction of many species, both on land and in water.

3. Volcanic Activity:

Cause: Intense volcanic eruptions can release vast quantities of volcanic gases, ash, and other materials into the atmosphere.

Effect: Volcanic activity can contribute to climate change by releasing greenhouse gases like carbon dioxide and sulfur dioxide. Additionally, ash clouds can block sunlight, leading to cooling effects. The combination of these factors can disrupt ecosystems, impact food chains, and contribute to species extinctions.

4. Changes in Sea Levels:

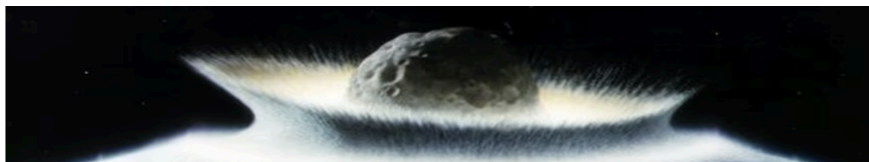
Cause: Sea levels can change over time due to factors such as melting ice caps, tectonic activity, or variations in Earth's orbit and axial tilt.

Effect: Rising sea levels can result in the flooding and loss of coastal habitats, affecting marine and terrestrial species. Conversely, falling sea levels can fragment aquatic habitats and impact species dependent on specific water depths. These changes can lead to population declines and, in extreme cases, extinctions.

5. Loss of Biodiversity and Habitat Destruction:

Cause: Human activities, such as deforestation, habitat destruction, pollution, and overexploitation of resources, can lead to significant biodiversity loss.

Effect: The loss of habitats and reduction in species diversity can disrupt ecosystems, decrease ecosystem resilience, and negatively impact the interconnected web of life. The extinction of one species can have cascading effects on other organisms within the ecosystem, potentially leading to further extinctions.



Activity: Using the information above make a summary of the types of events that could cause a mass extinction. List the effects of this event and give a rating (1-5) of the likelihood of this event occurring. Add any other research you like.

Extinction Cause	Effect	Likelihood
Climate change (global warming or cooling)	Temperature and rainfall change, habitats are lost, species cannot adapt - populations fall and species become extinct	4
Asteroid or comet impact	Fires, dust and debris block sunlight, tsunamis and rapid climate change - mass extinction on land and in the sea	2
Intense volcanic activity	Greenhouse gases and ash clouds change climate and block sunlight, disrupting food chains and causing extinctions	3
Changes in sea level (melting ice caps, tectonic activity, changes in Earth's orbit)	Coastal habitats are flooded or lost and shallow-water habitats fragment - marine and land populations decline then die out	3
Loss of biodiversity and habitat destruction (human activities)	Deforestation, pollution and overexploitation reduce ecosystem resilience, giving cascading extinctions through the food web	5

8ES 12c Mass Extinction Events Research



In your group, choose one of the known extinction events and make a slide including the following information:

- When it occurred (in MYA)
- What caused it
- What kind of life went extinct
- How/when it ended

Extension: Will there be a 6th mass extinction? Why or why not? When and how may it occur?

Very likely yes. Habitat destruction, climate change, pollution and overexploitation are pushing extinction rates far above background, so a sixth mass extinction could happen within the next few centuries unless biodiversity loss is stopped.

Yes, likely - human-driven habitat loss, climate change and pollution are pushing extinction rates far above the natural background; it could happen within the next few centuries.

8ES 13a Ice Ages

What is an ice age? An ice age is a period in Earth's history when the ice on the polar caps significantly expands due to a lowering of the Earth's global temperatures. Over the course of millions of years, scientists believe that the Earth has experienced at least five major ice ages. During these periods land in North America and Northern Europe were covered by giant ice sheets and glaciers. Earth is currently in an ice age called the Quaternary Ice Age which began around 2.5 million years ago and is still going on. We are currently in an interglacial stage of this ice age. The periods within ice ages are defined as:

- + **Glacial**- A glacial period is a cold period when the glaciers are expanding.
- + **Interglacial**- A warming period when the glaciers and ice sheets are receding.



INTERGLACIAL PERIOD

GLACIAL PERIOD

Earth System Research Laboratories Global Monitoring Laboratory. (n.d.). Problem Solving Activity: What Causes Ice Ages? Retrieved March 4, 2024, from https://gml.noaa.gov/outreach/info_activities/pdfs/PSA_ice_ages.pdf

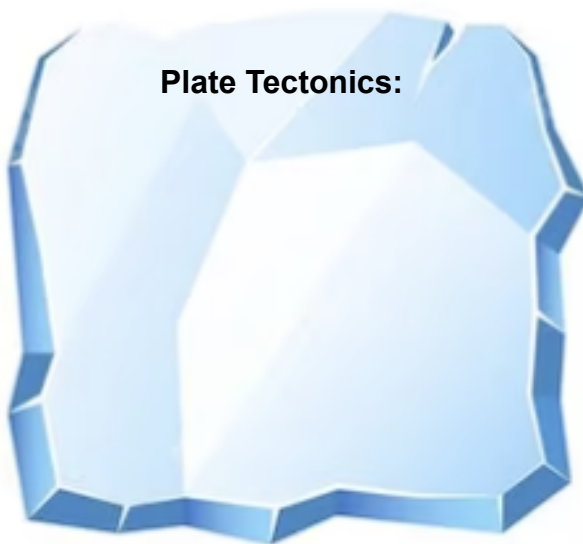
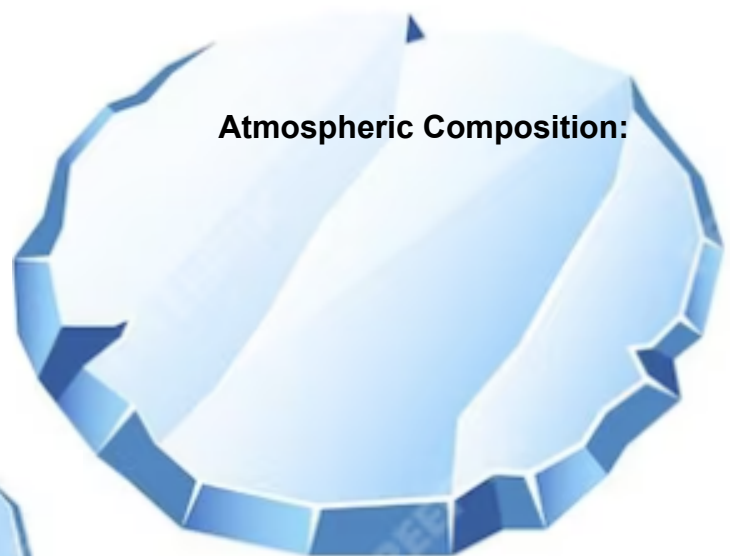
Write your own definition of an ice age:

An ice age is a long period of time, lasting millions of years, when global temperatures fall, ice sheets and glaciers grow and cover large areas of the continents.

8ES 13b Causes/Effects of Ice Ages



Activity:
Write down the details of each potential cause for Ice ages as discussed by your teacher



Amount of sunlight: ice ages begin when summer sunlight falling on northern high latitudes decreases (Milankovitch cycles of orbit shape, axial tilt and wobble), so snow does not melt and builds up into ice sheets.

Atmospheric composition: fewer greenhouse gases (e.g. less carbon dioxide) let heat escape to space so the planet cools; more volcanic CO₂ and dust can also change the temperature.

Global Competency: Citizenship, critical thinking

Approach to Learning: Creative thinking, information literacy, reflection

Plate tectonics: moving continents change ocean currents and winds, and mountain uplift or closing ocean gateways reduce heat carried to the poles, so ice sheets can grow.

Effects of an Ice Age: Fill in the missing words

Inland lakes and deep valleys can be made as Sea-levels drop allowing rivers to also carve out the landscape and change the topographic features. This is an example of Geological effects of ice ages.

Some animals thrive during an ice age while others go Extinct. The change in global temperatures will also cause mass migrations and may force adaptations. Overall there will be a very large change in biodiversity.

Extinct	rivers	biodiversity
Geological	Sea-levels	adaptations

Evidence for Ice Ages

Write down a definition and example of each type of evidence

Geological:

Geological evidence - definition: rock features left by moving ice. Example: striated (scratched) bedrock, U-shaped valleys and glacial till/moraine deposits.

Chemical:

Chemical evidence - definition: chemical traces in rocks, ice or shells that record cold conditions. Example: oxygen isotope ratios in ice cores and foraminifera shells.

Paleontological:

Paleontological evidence - definition: fossils of cold-adapted organisms. Example: woolly mammoth and reindeer remains found in areas that are now temperate.

8ES 14a Rise of the Mammals

Watch the video **From the Fall of Dinos to the Rise of Humans** and answer the following questions:

What is a stem animal?

A stem animal is an early member of a group that has some, but not all, of the features of later members - it sits on the stem of the evolutionary tree, before the group split.

What era are we in now? When did it start?

We are in the Cenozoic Era, the Age of Mammals; it began about 66 million years ago, straight after the K-P extinction that ended the Cretaceous.

What was the K-P (also known as K-T) extinction event that ended the cretaceous period?

The K-P extinction, about 66 MYA, was a mass extinction caused mainly by a huge asteroid impact (Chicxulub), probably with massive volcanic eruptions, which wiped out the non-bird dinosaurs.

What opportunities arose from the mass extinctions caused by the K-P event for the surviving life forms?

The dinosaurs left empty ecological niches, so the surviving mammals underwent adaptive radiation - they grew larger, spread into new habitats and evolved new diets.

What was the main diet for most early mammals?

Most early mammals were small insectivores - they ate insects (and later seeds and plants), feeding at night or in trees to avoid the dinosaurs.

What is a key feature of True Primates?

True primates have forward-facing eyes giving stereoscopic vision, grasping hands and feet with nails instead of claws, and a relatively large brain.

Global Competency: Citizenship, critical thinking

Approach to Learning: Creative thinking, information literacy, reflection

A lot of mammals went extinct about 49 MYA. What caused this?

Rapid global warming around 49 MYA, caused by huge greenhouse-gas release from volcanic activity and methane, changed climates and habitats so many mammals could not survive.

When did old world monkeys first appear?

Old World monkeys first appeared about 25-30 million years ago, in Africa and Asia.

Where did the first apes evolve? And what were some of their defining traits?

The first apes evolved in Africa around 25-20 MYA. Defining traits: no tail, larger body, flexible shoulders for climbing and swinging, and a bigger brain.

When did the genetic lineage of modern humans first appear? And when did the first Hominins first appear?

The genetic lineage of modern humans appeared about 6-7 MYA, when our line split from the chimpanzee line; the first hominins appeared about 6 MYA.

What ecosystem did hominins prefer?

Hominins preferred a mosaic (mixed) environment of woodland and grassland - savanna with scattered trees, where upright walking between clumps of trees was an advantage.

What current period are we in?

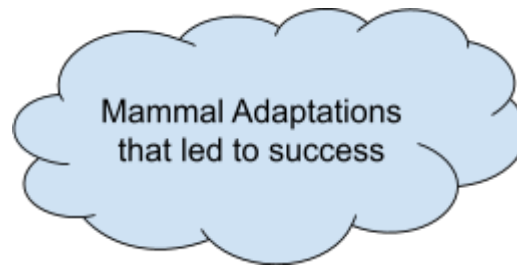
We are in the Quaternary Period of the Cenozoic Era, which began about 2.6 million years ago.

Cooling and drying climate, uplift of the East African Rift and the Himalayas, spreading savanna grasslands and ice-age land bridges replaced forests with open woodlands, favouring upright walking.

Extension: Research what may be some of the main geological changes that supported the rise of humans:

8ES 14b Adaptive Word Cloud

· Word cloud ideas: adaptation, natural selection, variation, mutation, survival, fitness, inheritance, environment, evolution, extinction, competition.



Global Competency: Citizenship, critical thinking

Approach to Learning: Creative thinking, information literacy, reflection

8ES 14c Intelligence

Research: Intelligence is a very difficult trait to measure, particularly across species. Compile a list of the top 10 most intelligent animals and how scientists measured their intelligence.

	Animal	Intelligence Measure
1	Human (<i>Homo sapiens</i>)	Encephalisation ratio (brain size to body size), language, tool making, mirror self-recognition tests
2	Chimpanzee	Tool use, mirror self-recognition, cooperative problem-solving tasks
3	Bottlenose dolphin	Mirror self-recognition, understanding human pointing/commands, problem-solving tasks
4	Orangutan	Tool use, puzzle-box problem solving and delayed gratification tests
5	African grey parrot	Vocabulary and label-learning tests, object permanence and counting tasks
6	Indian elephant	Mirror self-recognition and cooperation (rope-pulling) tests
7	New Caledonian crow	Tool-making and causal reasoning (metatool) tests
8	Octopus	Maze learning, problem-solving tasks and observational learning
9	Pig	Touchscreen and joystick tasks, mirror recognition, learning-speed tests
10	Dog	Word/command learning and social cue tests, e.g. following a human point

Practical: In groups rotate around the room at your teachers instructions and try to complete each of the intelligence test activities. Make sure you record your results!

8ES 15a Evolution of Humans

Evolution through Natural Selection

Natural selection: the process where organisms better adapted to their environment survive and reproduce more, so their useful inherited characteristics become more common over generations.

Write your own definition of Natural Selection here:

Evolution: the change in the inherited characteristics of a population over many generations, which over a long time can produce new species.

Write your own definition of Evolution here:

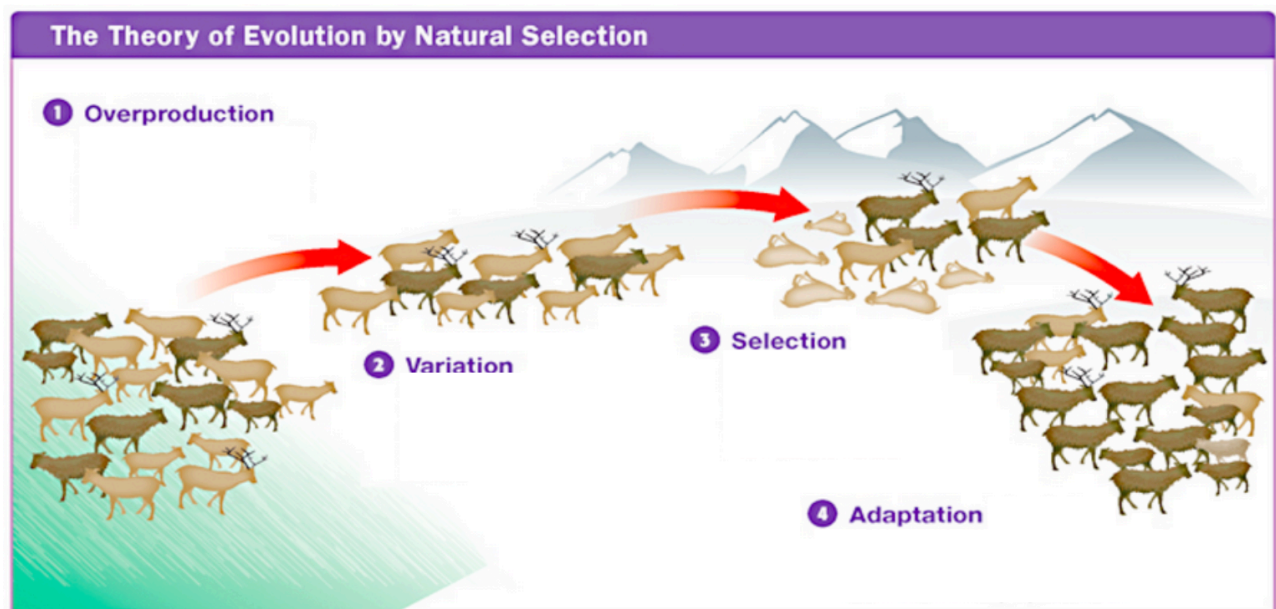
Draw a line from the description to the stage of evolution below:

The traits of those individuals that survive and reproduce will become more common in a population.

The individuals of a population have many characteristics that differ.

Every species tends to produce more individuals than can survive to maturity.

Some individuals survive longer and reproduce more than others do.



· Match each description to its stage, left to right: Australopithecus (walked upright, small brain, about 3.2 MYA) -> Homo habilis (first stone tool maker) -> Homo erectus (taller, larger brain, used fire) -> Homo sapiens (modern humans).

Global Competency: Citizenship, critical thinking

Approach to Learning: Creative thinking, information literacy, reflection

8ES 15b Evidence for Human Evolution

Find 3 pieces of evidence that support the idea of human evolution:

1. Fossils: hominin fossils such as *Australopithecus afarensis* (Lucy) show a mixture of ape and human features - a bipedal pelvis with an ape-sized brain.

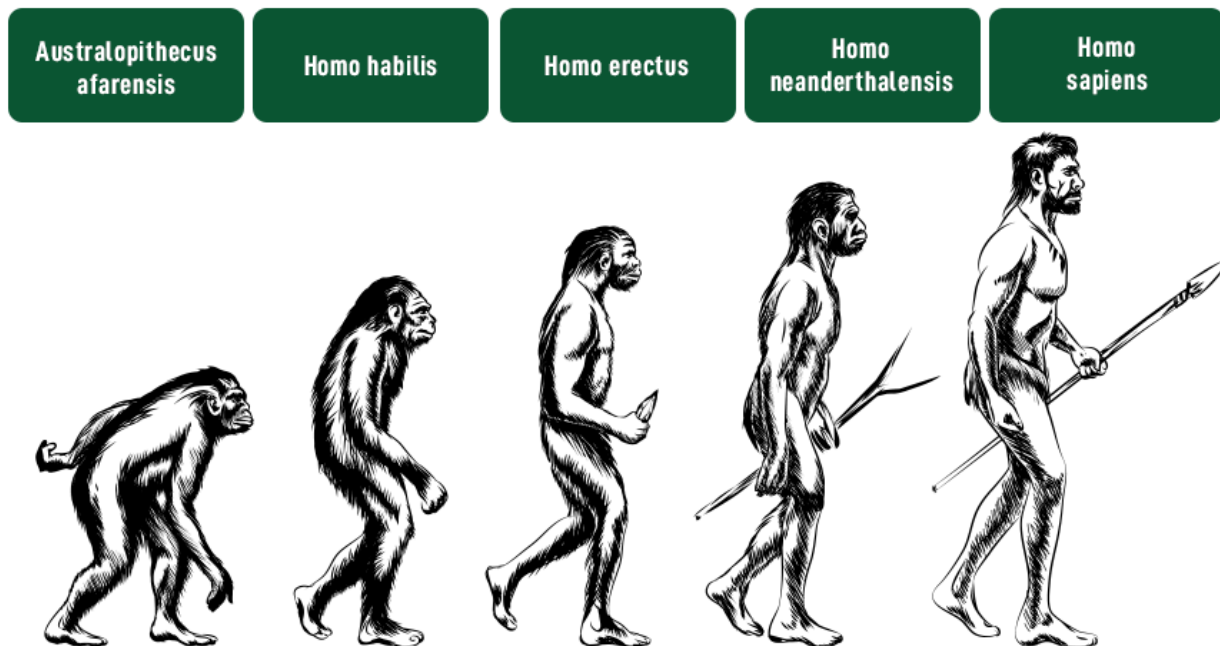
2. Comparative anatomy: humans have the same basic bone pattern as other primates, plus vestigial structures such as the tailbone (coccyx) and the appendix.

3. DNA/biochemistry: human and chimpanzee DNA is about 98-99% identical, and we share the same genetic code, proteins and blood-group molecules.

Extension. Why do you think some people do not believe in evolution? Some people hold religious or cultural beliefs about creation that appear to conflict with evolution; others misunderstand it as 'just a theory', think the fossil record has gaps, or distrust scientists.

Evolution conflicts with literal religious beliefs, is often misunderstood ('it is only a theory'), and some people prefer creationist explanations taught at home.

8ES 15c Timeline and Major Milestones



Jain, S. (2024, February 14). *Human Evolution - History & Stages of Human Evolution*. GeeksforGeeks. Retrieved March 11, 2024, from <https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/human-evolution-stages/>

Activity: Your group must write up an information sheet on **one** of the stages of the evolution of Homo Sapiens listed above. Your sheet must include:

- Approximate age of species
- Key anatomical traits
- Key behavioural traits
- Advantages of these traits
- Evidence for this species
- (A picture)

• Stages for the information sheet: Homo habilis (2.4 MYA, large brain, stone tools); Homo erectus (1.9 MYA, tall, used fire); Homo neanderthalensis (400000-40000 years, cold-adapted); Homo sapiens (300000 years, language, art).

Appendix - answers with no space on the original page

These belong to the printed question on the page shown.

p31: Matching: water flask/ocean water -> Ancient Oceans; gas mixture (methane, ammonia, hydrogen) -> Ancient atmosphere; electric spark discharge -> Lightning Storms.